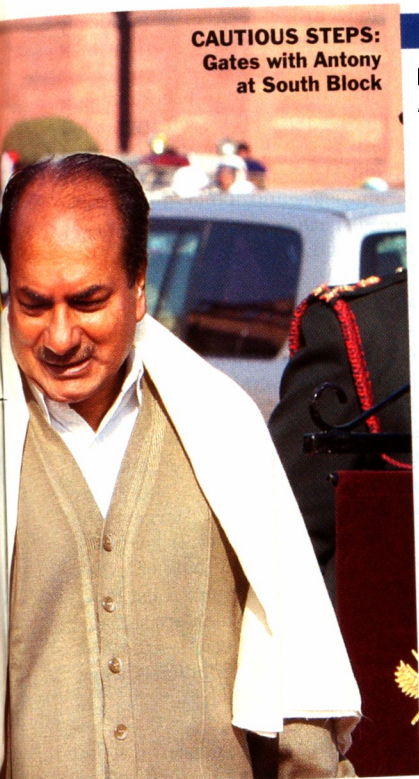


CAUTIOUS STEPS:
Gates with Antony
at South Block



WHY HE WAS HERE

Logistics Support Agreement:
Allows US ships and aircraft to be refuelled and vice versa.

Status: Matter pending with the Cabinet Committee on Security. Left Front opposed to it.

Communication Interoperability and Security Memorandum of Agreement:
A must for all countries that purchase US equipment.

Status: Yet to be ratified by India.

Arms Sales: India is buying maritime patrol aircraft, transport and heavy lift choppers worth over Rs 16,000 crore from the US.

Status: Price negotiations for P-8I maritime patrol aircraft have begun. Purchase of C-130J cleared.

End-user Agreement: India to allow inspection of sensitive military equipment sold by the US.

Status: India has not signed the agreement. Refused physical inspections, opted for end-user certificate.

(USA)—a barter arrangement which will allow India and the US to refuel each other's warships and embark stores while they are operating near each others' ports or airbases. At present both the governments pay for fuel and stores in cash.

Proposed nearly two years back by the US, the agreement is still pending before the Cabinet Committee on Security. However, in the face of strident protests from the Left—CP(M) General Secretary Prakash Karat called it far more dangerous than the nuclear deal—it has been shelved.

"At the moment, caution on the part of the Government is justified since we don't have domestic political consensus on future military ties with the US. But in the long term we need to increase ties with the US since defence cooperation is in our mutual interest," says Brigadier (retired) Gurmeet Kanwal, director of Centre for Land Warfare Studies. Gates was typically cautious as he said, "My sense was that there was a real commitment that both logistics and communications security agreement be completed as quickly as possible. But India is a better judge

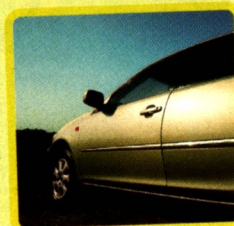
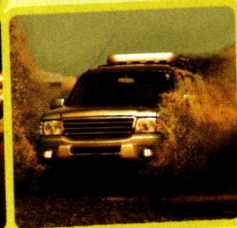


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